

Manuel Hidalgo-Pérez
Universidad Pablo de Olavide
Email: mhidper@upo.es

June 24, 2026

The Editors-in-Chief
Empirical Economics
Springer Nature

Dear Editors-in-Chief,

We are pleased to submit our original research manuscript entitled “**A Real-Time Forecasting-Ensemble Index of Economic Uncertainty and the Volatility of GDP Revisions**” for consideration for publication as a research article in *Empirical Economics*.

Our paper bridges a significant gap between two literature streams that have historically advanced in parallel: the literature on ex-post data revisions and the literature on ex-ante macroeconomic uncertainty measurement. We establish a formal and operational link showing that the internal disorder of a real-time forecasting system is a highly predictive ex-ante leading indicator of the magnitude of subsequent corrections in official GDP statistics.

Utilizing the real-time quarterly database of Spain’s *Contabilidad Nacional Trimestral* (CNTR) over the period 2015Q4–2024Q4, we construct a Composite Economic Uncertainty Index (CEUI) from three dimensions of a five-model ensemble (VAR, Random Forest, ARIMA, LSTM, and Dynamic Factor Models). The resulting index, computed under a strict quasi-real-time expanding-window protocol, exhibits a remarkably strong association ($\rho = 0.727$, $p < 0.001$) with the volatility of ex-post GDP growth revisions.

Key empirical contributions of our study include:

- **Methodological Bridging:** Decomposing forecast system disorder into within-model, between-model, and temporal instability dimensions under information-theoretic foundations.
- **Empirical Predictability:** Demonstrating that ex-ante forecasting disagreement and instability directly anticipate ex-post data quality corrections.
- **A Horse-Race Against Benchmarks:** Establishing that the CEUI carries specific informational content about statistical reliability that general uncertainty proxies, such as the VIX and the Economic Policy Uncertainty (EPU) index for Spain, do not capture.
- **Policy Implications:** Showing that the CEUI can serve as an objective, model-based “cautionary traffic light” for governments when calibrating major, irreversible policy reforms under conditions of acute data uncertainty.

We confirm that this manuscript is original, has not been published elsewhere, and is not currently under consideration by any other journal. We also declare that there are no conflicts of interest. All replication data, historical vintages, and Python code are publicly hosted on GitHub to ensure complete reproducibility.

Manuel Hidalgo-Pérez served as the lead author and investigator of this project.

Thank you for your time and consideration of our work. We look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Manuel Hidalgo-Pérez

Associate Professor of Economics

Universidad Pablo de Olavide